13 experts tested a horse that could do arithmetic.

> They found no trick.

Clever Hans tapped out answers with his hoof.

➕ Sums

🕰️ The time

🔤 Spelling

Led by Carl Stumpf, the panel found no fraud.

> They were right. There wasn't any.

Oskar Pfungst changed one thing:

> Did the person asking know the answer?

Same horse. Different questioner.

QUESTIONER KNEW

89% right

QUESTIONER DIDN'T

6% right

Hans read tiny body cues. People tensed near the answer. He stopped tapping.

An AI 'recognized' horses by a copyright watermark.

WATERMARK ON A CAR

"Horse"

WHAT IT LEARNED

The tag, not the horse

Hans was clever.

Just not at math.

The Hans test for any AI tool:

1. Ask what you can't answer
2. Verify it somewhere else
3. If it only works when you lead it, it's Hans